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# 两次卖掉埃菲尔铁塔的骗子

## *The Man Who Sold the Eiffel Tower Twice*



铁塔怎么成了骗子的“货物”？

# 英文原文

In 1925 six **scrap-metal traders** met **secretly** at the Hôtel de Crillon in Paris. A **deputy director-general** of the Ministry of Posts and Telegraphs shared the **momentous** news, **confidentially**, that the Eiffel Tower was to be sold for **scrap**. He invited **tenders** and made each dealer **solemnly vow secrecy**, **ostensibly** to spare the **public indignation**.

The **pretext** was not **absurd**. Built for the 1889 World's Fair, the **monument** had **originally** been **destined** to **come down** after twenty years. The **high-ranking** deputy was Victor Lustig, a **crook** whose **ministerial stationery** was a **forgery**. He had read a newspaper article in which the authorities **lamented** the **hefty cost** of the tower's **upkeep**.

André Poisson, a **businessman impatient** to **gain a foothold** in Paris, won. Lustig **intimated** that his modest **civil-service remuneration** needed **supplementing**, and Poisson paid an **additional bribe**. Lustig left for Vienna with the **takings**.

**Fleeced** and too **ashamed** to go to the police, Poisson swallowed the loss **quietly**. Not a **whisper** of the **deceit** appeared in print.

About a month later Lustig **had the gall to reappear** with an **encore** of his **script** for new dealers. This time the winner **grew distrustful** and went to the police. The **affair** made the papers, and Lustig made his **getaway**. The **much-repeated** second sale is a **fairy tale**.

Later arrested in the United States for making **fake** money, Lustig broke out of **detention**, was **recaptured** 27 days later and **served time** on the **penal** island of Alcatraz. He died of pneumonia in 1947.

Of Lustig's two marks, the one who paid **kept mum** and the one who kept his money went to the police.

# 中文译文

1925年，六名经营废金属的商人在巴黎的克里雍酒店秘密地会面了。邮电部的一位副的总负责人向他们私下地分享了一个重大的消息，埃菲尔铁塔将作为废铁出售。他请他们投标，并让每位商人郑重地发誓要保密，表面上是为了避免引起公愤。

这个借口并不荒唐。这座为1889年世博会而建的纪念建筑，原本就注定要在二十年后拆除。那位位高权重的副总长正是维克多·卢斯蒂格，一个骗子，他的那些部长的信笺都是伪造品。他曾读到过报纸上的一篇文章，文中当局哀叹铁塔维护的高昂费用。

安德烈·普瓦松，一个生意人，迫不及待地想在巴黎拥有一席之地，中标了。卢斯蒂格暗示，他那份微薄的公务员薪酬需要补贴，普瓦松然后付了一笔额外的贿赂。卢斯蒂格带着这笔进账去了维也纳。

被骗走钱财，又实在太丢人、没脸去报警，普瓦松只能默默地咽下这笔损失。关于这场骗局的半点风声报纸上没有出现。

大约一个月后，卢斯蒂格厚颜无耻地去再一次出现，对新的一批商人重演他那套剧本。这一次，那位中标者起了疑心，报了警。这桩事件上了报纸，卢斯蒂格逃之夭夭。那个被反复提及的第二次出售，只是个童话。

后来，卢斯蒂格在美国被捕，因为制造假币，他在关押（期间）越狱，27天后又被抓回，并在恶魔岛这座“刑罚之岛”上服刑。1947年，他死于肺炎。

卢斯蒂格的两个目标中，付了钱的那个守口如瓶，保住了钱的那个则去报了警。

# 词汇与表达

**scrap-metal** n.
废金属
*six scrap-metal traders*

**traders** n.
商人

**secretly** adv.
秘密地

**deputy** adj.
副的

**director-general** n.
总负责人

**momentous** adj.
重大的

**confidentially** adv.
私下地
*confidentially*

**scrap** n.
废铁
*was to be sold for scrap.*

**tenders** n.
投标
*He invited tenders*

**solemnly** adv.
郑重地

**vow** n.
发誓
*solemnly vow secrecy*

**secrecy** n.
保密

**ostensibly** adv.
表面上
*ostensibly to spare*

**public indignation** n.
公愤
*the public indignation*

**pretext** n.
借口
*The pretext was not absurd*

**absurd** adj.
荒唐

**monument** n.
纪念建筑

**originally** adv.
原本

**destined** adj.
注定
*destined to come down*

# 词汇与表达（续）

**come down** v.
拆除

**high-ranking** adj.
位高权重的

**crook** n.
骗子
*a crook*

**ministerial** adj.
部长的

**stationery** n.
信笺
*ministerial stationery*

**forgery** n.
伪造品
*was a forgery*

**lamented** v.
哀叹

**hefty cost** n.
高昂费用

**upkeep** n.
维护
*the tower's upkeep*

**businessman** n.
生意人

**impatient** adj.
迫不及待地

**gain a foothold** v.
拥有一席之地
*gain a foothold in Paris*

**intimated** v.
暗示
*Lustig intimated*

**civil-service** adj.
公务员

**remuneration** n.
薪酬
*civil-service remuneration*

**supplementing** v.
补贴

**additional** adj.
额外的

**bribe** n.
贿赂
*an additional bribe*

**takings** n.
进账

# 词汇与表达（续）

**Fleeced** v.
骗走
*Fleeced and too ashamed*

**ashamed** adj.
丢人……没脸

**quietly** adv.
默默地

**whisper** n.
风声

**deceit** n.
骗局
*a whisper of the deceit*

**had the gall to** v.
厚颜无耻地去
*had the gall to reappear*

**reappear** v.
再一次出现

**encore** n.
重演

**script** n.
剧本

**grew distrustful** v.
起了疑心
*the winner grew distrustful*

**affair** n.
事件

**getaway** n.
逃之夭夭

**much-repeated** adj.
被反复提及的

**fairy tale** n.
童话

**fake** adj.
假

**detention** n.
关押
*broke out of detention*

**recaptured** v.
抓回

**served time** v.
服刑

**penal** adj.
刑罚

**kept mum** v.
守口如瓶
*the one who paid kept mum*

# 文章简述

- 冒充：1925年，卢斯蒂格伪造公文、冒充邮电部官员，邀六名废金属商秘密投标，谎称埃菲尔铁塔要卖废铁。
- 借口：铁塔原拟在世博会20年后拆除，维护费又高；卢斯蒂格利用这些真背景，并以免引公愤为由要求保密。
- 得手：急于在巴黎立足的普瓦松付了购塔款和贿赂，受骗后却羞于报警，让卢斯蒂格带钱逃走。
- 再骗：约一月后，卢斯蒂格重演骗局，新买家起疑报警且未付款；所谓第二次卖成铁塔的故事并不成立。
- 下场：卢斯蒂格后来在美国因造假币被捕，越狱27天后再落网，在恶魔岛监狱服刑，1947年死于肺炎。